Supplier Proposal / RFP Response

CedarBridge Solutions | Fictional proposal for a configurable supplier-evaluation platform

Procurement context

The buyer seeks a configurable application to ingest competing supplier proposals, evaluate them against editable criteria, retain evidence, calculate deterministic peer benchmarks, and publish an explainable leaderboard. The solution must support different procurement categories through configurable criteria rather than category-specific scoring code. All suppliers are responding to this same sample requirement.

1. Executive summary and understanding

CedarBridge presents a balanced delivery plan with explicit milestones, named roles, user acceptance criteria and a mature support model. Its price is mid-range. The proposal is less detailed than Asterion on security architecture, and a few integration assumptions require confirmation.

2. Proposed solution and delivery approach

A configurable procurement workspace with a criteria editor, PDF extraction, provider abstraction for two LLM vendors, score normalization, deterministic ranking and JSON export. The solution separates document processing from ranking logic and includes a staged pilot before general release.

3. Timeline, team and milestones

Indicative delivery plan:

Milestone	Duration
Requirements and rubric workshop	2 weeks
Prototype with sample proposals	2 weeks
Core build and persistence	4 weeks
Security and user acceptance testing	2 weeks
Training and rollout	1 week

Proposed team

Delivery lead: accountable for scope and acceptance; solution architect: design and integrations; two application engineers: implementation; QA analyst: test planning and defect verification; enablement lead: training and handover. Named individuals and CVs are not supplied in this fictional proposal unless stated elsewhere.

4. Commercial proposal and assumptions

Cost component	Amount (INR)
Discovery and configuration	■4,00,000
Application development	■18,00,000
Testing and enablement	■3,00,000
Year-one support	■4,00,000
Total first-year estimate	■29,00,000

Commercial assumptions: amounts are fictional planning estimates in Indian rupees, exclusive of applicable taxes unless expressly included. Final price depends on scope confirmation, data volumes, hosting choice, integrations and acceptance criteria. The buyer should validate whether optional items and recurring cloud costs are included.

5. Security, compliance and risk controls

Includes role-based permissions, encrypted transport, secret-safe runtime configuration, audit trail and documented retention options. Encryption at rest depends on the selected hosting environment. The proposal lists a security test plan but does not attach an independent certification.

6. Support, experience and references

Support model: Provides a named service manager, 8x5 support, severity-based response targets, monthly reporting, quarterly improvement reviews and administrator training. Priority-one acknowledgement target is one hour during support hours.

Relevant experience: Reports four relevant deployments in procurement or document-heavy workflow settings. Two anonymized case studies include adoption and cycle-time measures; customer names and direct references are available subject to permission.

Evidence quality and limitations: Detailed milestone plan, responsibility matrix, acceptance criteria, support matrix and cost assumptions are included. Most claims are tied to a specific deliverable.

Key risks / open points: Security-at-rest responsibility depends on hosting choice; ERP integration scope requires discovery; response targets are acknowledgements, not guaranteed resolution times.

7. Clarifications requested

Before contract signature, the buyer should confirm data retention, hosting and data residency, user roles, integration endpoints, document volume, accessibility, service levels, tax treatment, acceptance criteria and ownership of custom code. Any item not explicitly committed above remains subject to clarification.

This document is synthetic test material created for an educational software project. Supplier names, prices, experience claims, timelines and references are fictional and must not be treated as real vendor claims.